did much more than give Haribabu the chance to earn some extra money. Santhan convinced Haribabu to believe that Rajiv Gandhi, as Prime Minister of India, was responsible for the mutilation of innocent Sri Lankan Tamils in Jaffna. Therefore, his return in the 1991 general election would result in the return of the IPKF, followed by fresh assaults on Sri Lankan Tamils.

The motive behind the conspiracy to kill Rajiv Gandhi was slowly emerging before the investigators.

In the other room, Murugan continued his story before Raju and Kanth. After assessing the groundwork done by Subramaniam and Muthuraja in Madras, Murugan thought it was time for him to enter the scene. He held meetings with Sivarasan in Jaffna and took the next step—sent two LTTE cadres, Jayakumar and Robert Payas, to Madras. Their primary task was to look for houses that could be used as hideouts. Murugan claimed that Jayakumar and Payas arrived in Madras in early February 1991 and stayed with Jayakumar's brother-in-law Arivu Peraribalan. He was a diploma holder in computer science and stayed in Sabari Nagar, Porur, a suburb of Madras. Although a dedicated member of the LTTE, Peraribalan had not taken part in any operation of the LTTE until Murugan approached him in the middle of February 1991. Murugan was impressed with his expertise in electronics.[10]

The assassins started getting to know each other. A sympathizer of the LTTE cause, Peraribalan was a little younger than twenty. In 1986 he had taken part in an anti-Rajiv Gandhi agitation and was imprisoned for fifteen days in Madras. Sundaram knew his father. The young boy had joined the Subha Studio in May 1989 when Muthuraja and Subramaniam used to frequent the place in search of fresh recruits for their operation. Peraribalan was exposed to the LTTE's plans for 'liberation' and started selling and distributing LTTE literature.[11]

He sold these books in public meetings. In Subha Studio he also came in contact with Bhagyanathan and Haribabu. He stayed with Bhagyanathan and Muthuraja for a short while. Soon he came in contact with a number of LTTE cadres who were all part of Prabhakaran's grand plan. As the